



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iceland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that — it's great that you're thinking seriously about your future at 16. In Denmark, there are several good educational paths after primary school (folkeskole), and the right one depends on your interests, goals, and how you prefer to learn. Since you're fluent in Danish and have a multicultural background, you have some advantages that can open doors in different directions. Here's a breakdown of your main options:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are academic programs that prepare you for university:

STX (Almen studentereksamen)

- Focus: Broad academic subjects (humanities, science, social science).
- Good for: University pathways, general education.
- Best if: You like studying theory and want to keep options open.

HHX (Højere handelseksamen)

- Focus: Business, economics, marketing.
- Good for: Business-related university programs or starting a business.
- Best if: You're interested in economics, languages, or international business.

HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)

- Focus: Technology, natural sciences, IT.
- Good for: Engineering, tech, science careers.
- Best if: You like STEM subjects and practical applications.

HF (Højere forberedelseksamen)

- Focus: Shorter, more flexible, often for those who want to enter certain professions or adult education.
- Good for: Those who want a more direct path to certain higher education options (e.g., teaching, nursing).
- Best if: You want a 2-year, more mature environment or didn't enjoy school as much.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

- Combines school and apprenticeships (praktik).
- You become qualified for a profession like electrician, carpenter, hairdresser, mechanic, etc.
- Great if you like **hands-on** work and want to enter the workforce sooner.
- Also includes **EUX**: a combination of vocational training and gymnasial-level education, giving both a trade and access to higher education.

3. International or Nordic Options

Since you have Icelandic roots and speak Danish:

- **Consider international programs** (e.g., IB – International Baccalaureate) if you're strong in English and may want to study abroad.
- **Check Icelandic education opportunities** too — some Danish/Icelandic citizens explore exchange or study in both countries.

Some Questions to Reflect On:

- Do you enjoy academic subjects and theory, or prefer practical, hands-on work?
- Do you see yourself going to university?
- Are you interested in business, technology, arts, health, or trades?
- Would you enjoy an international career or staying in Denmark?

My Advice

Based on what you've shared and assuming you're keeping options open:

- **If you're academically inclined and want flexibility:** Consider **STX**.
- **If you're interested in business or international careers:** Look at **HHX** or **IB**.
- **If you love building, fixing, or creating things:** **EUD** or **HTX** might be perfect.
- **If you're not sure yet:** STX or HF gives you time and broad knowledge to decide later.

If you'd like, I can help you explore specific schools near you in Denmark or even help you map out a possible career path based on your interests. Want to dive deeper?